

Case Metadata

Field	Value
Case ID:	CS-2025-005
Case Type:	Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce
Reported by:	Splunk SIEM
Analyst:	Ali YILMAZ
Date:	2025-10-05
Severity:	Medium (High - escalate if successful)
Status:	Closed
Environment:	Production

Detection Rule Details

Rule Name: Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce

Rule Description: The following analytic has been deprecated in favor of "Windows Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce Attempt". The following analytic identifies potential Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) brute force attacks by monitoring network traffic for RDP application activity. This query detects potential RDP brute force attacks by identifying source IPs that have made more than 10 successful connection attempts to the same RDP port on a host within a one-hour window. The results are presented in a table that includes the source and destination IPs, destination port, number of attempts, and the times of the first and last connection attempts, helping to prioritize IPs based on the intensity of activity.

Correlation Rule (SPL):

```
tstats `security_content_summariesonly` count min(_time) as firstTime max(_time) as lastTime from datamodel=Network_Traffic where All_Traffic.app=rdp by All_Traffic.src All_Traffic.dest All_Traffic.dest_port
```

```
| eventstats stdev(count) AS stdev avg(count) AS avg p50(count) AS p50
```

```
| where count>(avg + stdev*2)
```

```
| rename All_Traffic.src AS src All_Traffic.dest AS dest
```

```
| table firstTime lastTime src dest count avg p50 stdev
```

| `remote\_desktop\_network\_bruteforce\_filter`

Triggered Field(s):

T1021 - Remote Services Remote Desktop Protocol

Detection Summary

This analytic was previously used to detect potential **Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) brute-force attacks** by monitoring network traffic for RDP activity.

It identifies source IPs that have made more than **10 successful connection attempts** to the same RDP port on a host within a one-hour window.

The results include the **source and destination IPs, destination port, number of attempts**, and the **timestamps** of the first and last connections, allowing analysts to prioritize suspicious IPs based on the intensity of activity.

This version of the analytic has since been **deprecated** in favor of the updated rule **“Windows Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce Attempt.”**

Initial severity: Medium

Analyst Investigation

- Checked the notable's source and destination IPs (88.214.251.23 → 96.73.98.186:2050) via VirusTotal and AbuseIPDB → Clean.
- Reviewed event logs: all actions were tied to Splunk internal job (scheduler__admin_REEtRVNTLUNvbnRIbnRVcGRhdGU).
- Verified that no Windows event logs (4625/4624) or network traffic supported actual brute-force attempts.
- Confirmed the notable was part of an ESCU validation/test dataset used for training.

Investigation Steps:

- **Reviewed notable in Splunk Enterprise Security (Incident Review).**
Confirmed the correlation search triggered by **“ESCU – Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce – Rule.”**
- **Checked job details and metadata.**
Verified the event originated from **scheduler__admin / DA-ESS-ContentUpdate**, indicating a system-generated validation task.
- **Inspected source and destination IPs (88.214.251.23 → 96.73.98.186:2050).**
Queried in **VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB, and FortiGuard** — all results clean.
- **Searched for related Windows Security events (EventCodes 4625 / 4624)** and RDP logs within the same timeframe.
No real brute-force authentication attempts found.

- **Reviewed rule documentation in ESCU.**
Confirmed the analytic has been deprecated and replaced by **“Windows Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce Attempt.”**
- **Correlated findings.**
Activity confirmed as **test/training data** generated by Splunk content validation; no external threat actor activity observed.

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

T1021 - Remote Services Remote Desktop Protocol

 True Positive (Benign)

Explanation: The “Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce” correlation rule correctly identified simulated RDP brute force behavior generated as part of a training or content validation activity. No malicious intent or external threat was involved.

Recommended Actions

- **Acknowledge and close the notable** in Splunk Enterprise Security with disposition set to **True Positive (Benign)** – simulated detection from content validation.
- **Add an analyst note** indicating that the alert was generated by the **DA-ESS-ContentUpdate** scheduler job for analytic validation.
- **Keep the correlation rule enabled** to ensure continued visibility for real RDP brute-force attempts.
- **Monitor for future notables** from the updated analytic **“Windows Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce Attempt.”**
- **Perform periodic review** of test and validation alerts to prevent alert fatigue in the Incident Review dashboard.
- **Validate RDP hardening measures** remain in place (strong password policy, account lockout thresholds, limited exposure of port 3389).

Organizational / HR Actions

- Notify SOC lead that the alert was part of a training/test scenario.
- Document the case for analyst reference.
- Keep RDP access policy and detection rules up to date.
- Remind analysts how to recognize system-generated alerts.

Business Impact

- No real security impact.
The alert originated from a training or validation activity — no systems or data were affected.

Evidence in Case

- Splunk ES Incident Review screenshot (notable details)
- Splunk Search screenshot showing DA-ESS-ContentUpdate job
- Rule: *ESCU – Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce – Rule*
- Job ID:
scheduler__admin_REEtRVNTLUNvbnRIbnRVcGRhdGU__RMD52911350c52b9af6b

The screenshot displays the Splunk Enterprise Security (ES) Incident Review interface. The top navigation bar includes links for Security Posture, Incident Review (active), Investigations, Security Intelligence, Security Domains, Cloud Security, Audit, Search, and Configure. The user is Ali Yilmaz, and there are 998 messages. The interface shows a search for "Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce" with filters for Tag, Urgency, Status, Owner, Security Domain, Type, Search Type, and Time or Associations. The results show 186 Notables, with the first notable event being "Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce" (Risk Score: 2050, Urgency: Low, Status: New, Owner: unassigned).

Description:

The following analytic has been deprecated in favor of "Windows Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce Attempt". The following analytic identifies potential Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) brute force attacks by monitoring network traffic for RDP application activity. This query detects potential RDP brute force attacks by identifying source IPs that have made more than 10 successful connection attempts to the same RDP port on a host within a one-hour window. The results are presented in a table that includes the source and destination IPs, destination port, number of attempts, and the times of the first and last connection attempts, helping to prioritize IPs based on the intensity of activity.

Related Investigations:

Currently not investigated.

Correlation Search:

[ESCU - Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce - Rule](#)

History:

[View all review activity for this Notable Event](#)

Adaptive Responses:

Response	Mode	Time	User	Status
Risk Analysis	saved	2025-10-08T06:46:29-0400	admin	✓ success
Notable	saved	2025-10-08T06:46:28-0400	admin	✓ success

[View Adaptive Response Invocations](#)

Next Steps:

No next steps defined.

Additional Fields

Field	Value	Action
Annotations	CIS 12	▼
	CIS 16	▼
	SamSam Ransomware	▼
	PR.AC	▼
	Reconnaissance	▼
	T1021.001	▼
	DE.AE	▼
	Ryuk Ransomware	▼
	T1021	▼
	CIS 9	▼
	PR.IP	▼
	Delivery	▼
Annotation Framework	analytic_story	▼
	cis20	▼
	kill_chain_phases	▼
	mitre_attack	▼
	nist	▼
Destination	96.73.98.186 2050	▼
Risk Score	2050	▼
Severity	low	▼
Source	88.214.25.123 0	▼

Event Details:

Field	Value
event_id	FC5EF1EF-0E6E-4C54-902C-4CB2803883E5@notable@b25940e89e9e5e61d6a781ddae0076b9
event_hash	b25940e89e9e5e61d6a781ddae0076b9
eventtype	modnotable_results
	notable
Short ID	Create Short ID

Save As ▾ Create Table View Close

Date time range ▾ 

Job ▾ || ▮ ↗ 🔍 ⚙️ ! Smart Mode ▾

Format Timeline ▾ − Zoom Out + Zoom to Selection × Deselect

100%

All Fields

```
a host 1
a source 2
a sourcetype 2
```

```
a action_mode 1
a action_name 2
a action_status 1
a app 1
a component 1
# date_hour 1
# date_mday 1
# date_minute 1
a date_month 1
# date_second 2
a date_wday 1
# date_year 1
# date_zone 1
# digest_mode 1
# duration 2
# event_count 1
a eventtype 2
a index 1
# linecount 1
a punct 2
# rid 1
a search_name 1
a sid 1
a signature 4
a splunk_server 1
a tag 2
a tag:eventtype 2
# timeendpos 1
# timestamp 1
a user 1
a worker 1
```

```
10/8/25 2025-10-08 10:46:29.6660000 INFO sendmodaction - worker="splunk-prod" signature="Modular action script duration" action_name="risk" search_name="FESCU-6:46:29.662 AM Remote Desktop Network BruteForce - Rule" sid="scheduler_admin_REETIRVNTLUNvbn1bnRvCGrhGU_RM052911350c52b9af6b_at.1759917600_95239" rid="0" app="DA-ES S-ContentUpdate" user="admin" digest_mode="1" action_mode="saved" component="main" duration="27"
```

2.

Type	Field	Value	Action
Selected	host ▾	splunk-prod	▾
	source ▾	/data/splunk/var/log/splunk/risk_modalert.log	▾
	sourcetype ▾	modular_alerts:risk	▾
Event	action_mode ▾	saved	▾
	action_name ▾	risk	▾
	app ▾	DA-ESS-ContentUpdate	▾
	component ▾	main	▾
	digest_mode ▾	1	▾
	duration ▾	27	▾
	eventtype ▾	cim_modaction (modaction)	▾
	rid ▾	0	▾
	search_name ▾	ESCU - Remote Desktop Network Bruteforce - Rule	▾
Time ⚙️	sid ▾	scheduler__admin_REERVNTLUNvbnRtbnRvcGRhdGU_RMD52911350c52b9af6b_at_1759917600_95239	▾
	signature ▾	Modular action script duration	▾
	tag ▾	modaction	▾
	user ▾	admin	▾
	worker ▾	splunk-prod	▾
	_time ▾	2025-10-08T06:46:29.662-04:00	▾
Default	index ▾	cim_modactions	▾
	linecount ▾	1	▾
	punct ▾	--::+---:-::-:"--:"--:"--:"--:"--:"--:"--:"--:"--:"--:"--:"--:	▾
	splunk_server ▾	splunk-prod	▾

```

> 10/8/25      2025-10-08 10:46:29,6610000 INFO sendmodaction - worker="splunk-prod" signature="Successfully created splunk events" action_name="risk" search_name="ESC
6:46:29.661 AM U - Remote Desktop Network BruteForce - Rule" sid=scheduler_admin_PEErVRNTLUNvNbnRbVRCgHdGLRQMS291350c5269af6bb.at.1759917600_95239 rid="0" app="D
A-ESS-ContentUpdate" user="admin" digest_mode="1" action_model="saved" event_count="1"
host=splunk-prod source="/data/splunk/var/log/splunk/risk_modelalert.log" sourcetype = modular_alertsrisk

```

```

> 10/8/25 2025-10-08 10:46:28,858+0000 INFO sendmodaction - worker="splunk-prod" signature="Modular action script duration" action_name="notable" search_name="ESCU
6:46:28.858 AM - Remote Desktop Network BruteForce - Rule" sid="scheduler_admin_RECIRWNTUWbRnRlbnRvcGRhZGQ_RMD5291350832b9a6b_at_1759917600_95239" rid="68" app="DA-
ESS-ContentUpdate" user="admin" digest_mode="1" action_mode="saved" component="main" duration="15"
host="splunk-prod" source="/data/splunk/var/lib/splunk/notable/modular.log" source_type="modular_actions_notable"

```

```
host = splunkprod; source = /data/splunk/var/log/splunk/notable; splunkd_log; sourcetype = modular_created; notable
```

> 10/8/25 2025-10-08 10:46:28,858+0000 INFO sendmodaction - worker='splunkprod' signature='Successfully created splunk events' action_name='notable' search_name='ESCU - Remote Desktop Network BruteForce - Rule' sid='scheduler_admin_REMOTEINTLWbvrnRlbnKvGrhGd_RND52911350c52b9af6b_at_1759917600_95239' rid='0' ppid='DA-ESS-ContentUpload' user='admin' digest='mod=1' action_mode='saved' event_count='1'

data_scheduled_source = /data/splunk/var/log/splunk/notable; modification = savedmodaction; notable

host = splunk-prod	source = /data/splunk/var/log/splunk/notable_modalert.log	sourcetype = modular_alerts.notable
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AbuseIPDB » 88.214.25.123

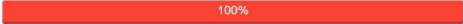
Check an IP Address, Domain Name, or Subnet
e.g. 178.193.246.50, microsoft.com, or 5.188.10.0/24

88.214.25.123

CHECK

88.214.25.123 was found in our database!

This IP was reported 9,597 times. Confidence of Abuse is 100%: ?



ISP	VDS&VPN services
Usage Type	Data Center/Web Hosting/Transit
ASN	AS35042
Domain Name	one-host.net
Country	 Germany
City	Frankfurt am Main, Hesse

IP info including ISP, Usage Type, and Location provided by IPInfo. Updated biweekly.

REPORT 88.214.25.123

WHOIS 88.214.25.123

IP Abuse Reports for 88.214.25.123:

This IP address has been reported a total of 9,597 times from 430 distinct sources. 88.214.25.123 was first reported on July 12th 2024, and the most recent report was 17 minutes ago.

Recent Reports: We have received reports of abusive activity from this IP address within the last week. It is potentially still actively engaged in abusive activities.

Reporter	IoA Timestamp (UTC)	Comment	Categories
 Unwasted	2025-10-08 11:07:22 (17 minutes ago)	Abusive content scan (abuse_score>80)	Hacking Brute-Force Web App Attack
 Study Bitcoin	2025-10-08 10:14:28 (1 hour ago)	Port probe to tcp/9959 [srv129]	Port Scan
 MPL	2025-10-08 09:13:23 (2 hours ago)	tcp/3389 (9 or more attempts)	Port Scan
 rtbh.com.tr	2025-10-08 08:09:13 (3 hours ago)	list.rtbh.com.tr report: tcp/3389	Brute-Force
 guldkage	2025-10-08 08:00:50 (3 hours ago)	Unauthorized connection attempt detected from IP address 88.214.25.123 to port 3306 (uk-01) [MYSQL]	Exploited Host
 Study Bitcoin	2025-10-08 08:00:39 (3 hours ago)	Port probe to tcp/2022 (down) [srv132]	Port Scan
 Largnet SOC	2025-10-08 07:42:29 (3 hours ago)	88.214.25.123 triggered Icarus honeypot on port 3389. Check us out on github.	Port Scan Hacking
 MazenHost	2025-10-08 07:16:22 (4 hours ago)	1759907781 - 10/08/2025 10:16:21 Host: 88.214.25.12 3/88.214.25.123 Port: 15 TCP Blocked ...	Port Scan
 Grizzlylooks	2025-10-08 05:36:30 (5 hours ago)	Kingcopy(AI-IDS)RouterOS: Portscanner detected.	Port Scan
 beqou.dev	2025-10-08 05:14:04 (6 hours ago)	[Threat Intelligence] Port Scanning and/or Unauthorized access -> TCP/389	Port Scan
 mikrolik.al	2025-10-08 04:21:39 (7 hours ago)	10/08/2025-04:21:39.106155 88.214.25.123 Protocol: 6 ET SCAN MS Terminal Server Traffic on Non-stand ... show more	Port Scan
 rtbh.com.tr	2025-10-08 04:09:14 (7 hours ago)	list.rtbh.com.tr report: tcp/3389	Brute-Force
 sgamverify.com	2025-10-08 03:53:53 (7 hours ago)	Honeypot Hit: Port Scan (7687) NEO4J	Web Spam Blog Spam Bad Web Bot Web App Attack
 bontekoe.technology	2025-10-08 03:16:05 (8 hours ago)	88.214.25.123 banned on rtr - Threshold reached: 3 failures	Web App Attack
 MPL	2025-10-08 03:11:13 (8 hours ago)	tcp/3389 (6 or more attempts)	Port Scan

Is this your IP? You may request to takedown any associated reports. We will attempt to verify your ownership. [REQUEST TAKEDOWN](#)

Recently Reported IPs:

 2.57.121.25	 103.172.205.208	 218.78.104.226	 5.135.71.246
 172.217.32.158	 5.129.243.195	 61.191.145.123	 20.83.27.168
 1.220.119.116	 144.48.8.10	 201.17.133.138	 103.176.78.178
 80.94.93.233	 219.155.194.4	 51.159.93.41	 35.222.117.243
 27.79.6.35	 91.224.92.108	 199.45.154.138	 14.103.128.118



